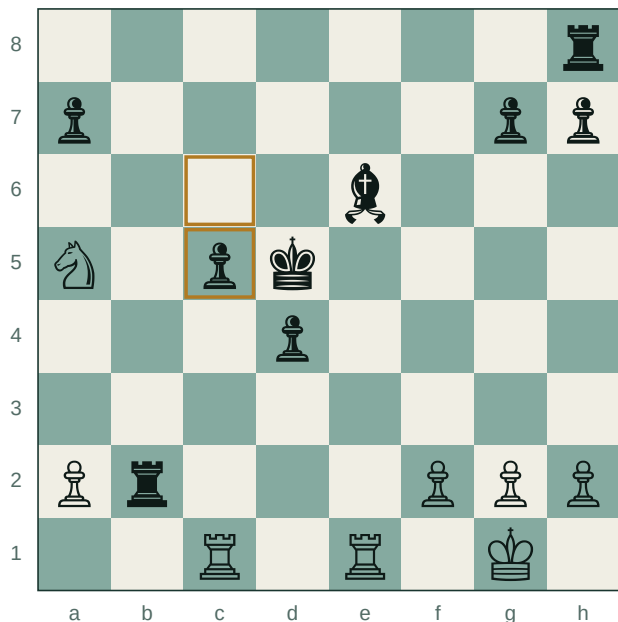


Deflection tactics: White, move 27

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 26...c5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

27. Nc4 Rxa2 28. Re5+ Kc6 29. Rxe6+

27.Nc4 The knight moves from a5 to c4. Recorded reply: **27...Rxa2**.

28.Re5+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From e5 it attacks king on d5 and bishop on e6. Recorded reply: **28...Kc6**.

29.Rxe6+ Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. The move also takes the bishop on e6.

At the end, nominal material is White 16 / Black 15 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +2: the balance goes from -1 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on d5. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8 and rook on b2. Check for tactical protection.